



YOUTH CONNECT · ERASMUS+ KA210

Workshop 1: Digital Life Map & Storytelling

A first session to map where everyone stood with technology and to start telling their own professional story.

10 participants

Young men, 18+

Morocco & Senegal

120 minutes

Our first session put together two things: a quick look at everyone's relationship with technology and a storytelling workshop. The idea was simple. We wanted participants to notice the digital skills they already have, gain a bit of confidence, get to know each other, and find a visual, low-pressure way to talk about what they can do, both personally and at work. The group was ten young men, all over eighteen, originally from Morocco and Senegal.

ICEBREAKER

We opened with an icebreaker to loosen things up and help everyone learn names. Standing in a circle, participants and facilitators played a simple name game. It worked well: the group warmed up quickly and people stayed involved for the rest of the session. Funnily enough, the names came easier to the participants than to us facilitators.

DIGITAL LIFE MAP

Next came the "Digital Life Map", an activity to get people thinking about their own digital habits, how confident they feel and what they would like to learn. We were careful to frame it as a personal reflection, not a test, so everyone felt free to talk openly about how they use technology.

As the conversation went on, a clear picture emerged: most of the group were comfortable with smartphones and social media, but not much beyond that. Phones for messaging and calls, no problem. Email, writing documents or using a computer at work were a different story, and several people said they found those hard.

This was genuinely useful. It gave us a real sense of the starting point and let us adapt the following sessions to the group instead of to a plan on paper. It also confirmed something we will carry into future employability workshops: basic digital literacy has to be part of the package.

DISCOVERING SKILLS THROUGH IMAGES

The next activity was about spotting personal strengths and work skills, and we did it visually, which helped a lot given the different levels of Spanish in the room. We laid out images representing qualities and ways of behaving at work: teamwork, punctuality, responsibility, perseverance, helping others, and so on.

In two groups, each person picked the five images that felt most like them, with a hand from us when needed. We helped connect those images to Spanish words people could use to describe themselves at work, like "responsable", "amable", "trabajador" and "polivalente". One thing stood out in the discussion: a lot of participants chose images about helping and supporting others, and talked about solidarity, cooperation and kindness as things they value.

The activity also opened the door to talking about past jobs, using images of different workplaces and trades. Most of the group had worked mainly in kitchens or in seasonal farm work, following the harvests across different parts of Spain.

BUILDING A PERSONAL STORY

From there we moved into a storytelling exercise, building a short personal narrative out of the skills we had just talked about. Using images of different professions, each person reflected on three things: the work they had done, what they can do now, and where they would like to go next.

Telling it through images made it much easier to organise ideas and to put into words parts of their journey that can be hard to explain otherwise. We wrote down what came out of this, and it will be the starting material for the CV and employability sessions later on.

We had originally planned to do this in Canva, but the first activity made it clear the app was new to almost everyone. So we kept this one off-screen and decided it was better to revisit it during the "Basics of Canva" workshop, where they could turn it into something digital.

THE SUITCASE OF STORIES

We finished with a creative activity we call "The Suitcase of Stories": a box full of objects, things like shells, sports gear and tools, set out for the group.

Everyone, facilitators included, picked an object that said something about who they are, what they like or where they have been. Then, in small groups of three, people asked questions and tried to guess which object each person had chosen before explaining what it meant to them. It led to some really nice conversations and helped people find things they had in common.

All in all, the session brought together digital reflection, self-awareness, storytelling and group building. People were shy at the start, but they opened up as the morning went on, and it was clear they felt more at ease sharing in small groups than in front of everyone.